

Parliamentary Procedure

Quick reference for committee — points, motions, voting, speeches, caucuses

POINTS

Action	Purpose	Requirements	Tactical note
Point of Order	Procedural error has occurred. Must be addressed immediately.	Interrupts current speaker	Raise placard. State 'Point of Order'.
Point of Privilege	Can't participate effectively (can't hear, health issue).	Interrupts current speaker	Raise placard. State 'Point of Personal Privilege'.
Point of Information	Question for a delegate who just spoke, or resolution sponsors.	After speaker finishes	Speaker chooses whether to accept.
Point of Inquiry	Question about procedure directed at the Chair.	During debate	Chair answers directly.

MOTIONS

Motion	Purpose	Requirements	Note
Open Speakers List	Begin formal debate	Requires a second	Standard opening move
Moderated Caucus	Structured discussion on a subtopic	Topic + speaker time + total time. Simple majority.	Specify all three parameters.
Unmoderated Caucus	Informal negotiation period	Duration. Simple majority.	Where resolutions are built.
Close Debate	Move to immediate vote	Second + 2/3 majority.	No further amendments after.
Adjourn Debate	Temporarily pause debate	Simple majority.	Resolution stays on agenda.

VOTING

Option	Meaning	Counted in majority?	Use when
Yes	In favour	Yes	Supporting the resolution.
No	Against	Yes	Opposing the resolution.
Abstain	Neither	No	Not opposing but not endorsing.
Pass	Defer your vote	—	Use once; must vote on recall.

SPEECHES

Speech type	Purpose	Timing	Key rule
Opening Speech	State your country's position	Speakers list	State position in first sentence.

Speech type	Purpose	Timing	Key rule
Yield to Delegate	Give remaining time to another	After your speech	Cannot be refused by Chair.
Yield to Questions	Allow questions on remaining time	After your speech	You choose which to accept.
Yield to Chair	Return remaining time	After your speech	Most common yield.
Right of Reply	Respond to direct unfair citation	After citing speech	Must request before next speaker.

CAUCUSING

Type	Purpose	Procedure	Tactical note
Moderated Caucus	Formal timed discussion. On record.	Motion: topic + speaker time + total. Majority.	Stay seated. Speak when recognised.
Unmoderated Caucus	Informal negotiation. Move freely.	Motion: duration. Majority.	Listen first. Commit to language late.
Working Paper	Early resolution draft	Circulate informally.	Not before committee until submitted.
Lobbying	Direct negotiation	Unmoderated caucus.	Understand objections before drafting.

Simple majority = 50% + 1 of delegates present and voting. **Abstentions** are NOT counted in the denominator. **2/3 majority** required for closure of debate and some substantive votes. Points **cannot** be debated — they must be addressed immediately by the Chair.